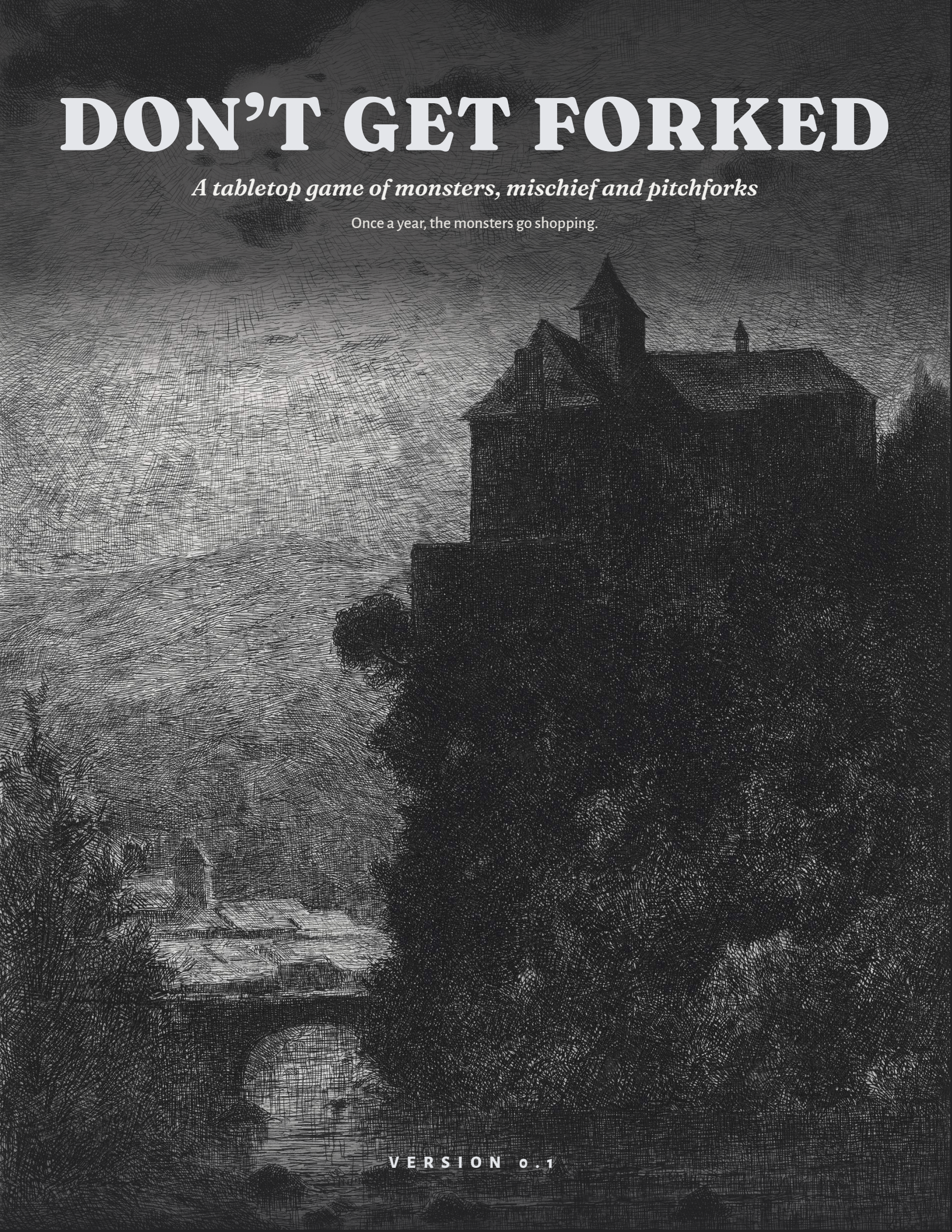


DON'T GET FORKED

A tabletop game of monsters, mischief and pitchforks

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.

VERSION 0.1

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GAME DESIGN & WRITING

Richard Moore

STAND-IN ILLUSTRATIONS

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PART ONE

Playing the Game

The Entities, the dice, the raid, Suspicion, the chase and how the year went: everything the players need at the table.





CHAPTER 1

The Game

You play classic monsters who share a castle in the woods. Once a year, on Lantern Night, the town's festival, when everyone is in costume, you go down to steal what the castle needs. Get the shopping list home before dawn — and if the job goes wrong, outrun the mob before it corners you with pitchforks.

What a Raid Is

Each **raid** is on a new town and stands alone: nothing from earlier raids carries over, unless your group uses the optional campaign rules (Chapter 7). A raid runs **1–2 hours**, so an evening often fits two. *In the story, every raid is the year's first stock-up.*

The Storyteller chooses how hard the town is: **Easy, Standard or Hard** (Chapter 8). The choice sets the shopping list's size, the Suspicion Limit and a few other numbers. It isn't an obstacle's Difficulty, the number you roll against (Chapter 3).

Who Plays

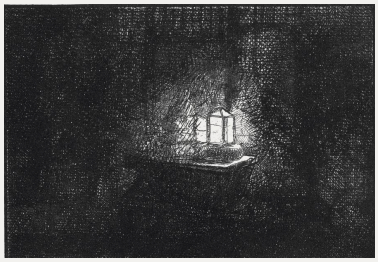
3–5 players each play one of the eight **Entities**. One more person is the **Storyteller**, who runs the town, its villagers and the mob. The tone is horror-comedy for about 12 and up: real stakes, dark jokes, nothing gory.

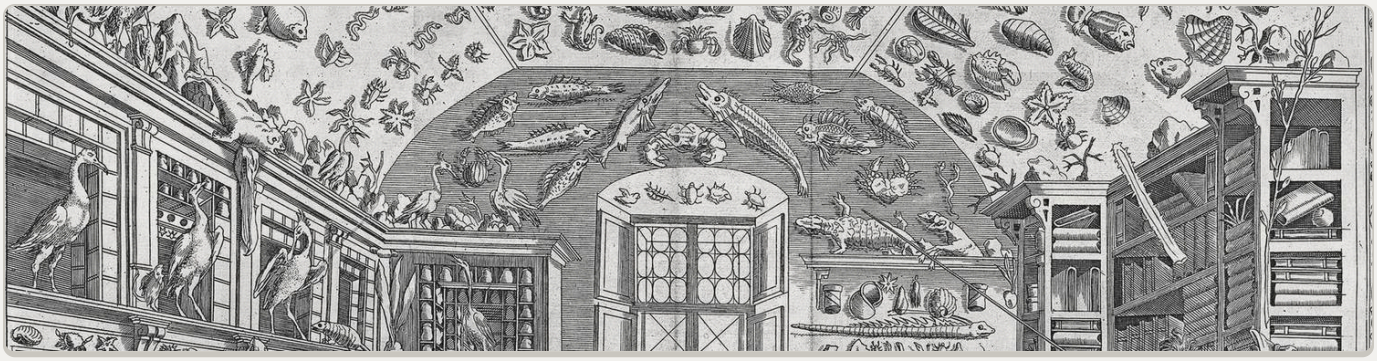
What You Need

- Each player: one each of d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12 (the trait dice, Chapter 2), plus a second d6 (the Mask) and a second d10 (the Monster).
- The Storyteller: a d20. When Chapter 8 calls for a d3, roll a d6, halve it and round up.
- An Entity Sheet for each player (copy the one at the back of the book), and something to track Suspicion (Chapter 5), Turns (Chapter 4) and the Lead (Chapter 6).
- A town to raid: a premade one (Chapter 9), or one the Storyteller draws on a map or rolls on the random tables (Chapter 8).

THE RAID AT A GLANCE

- The Storyteller rolls the **shopping list**: one or two essentials, the rest extras (Chapter 4).
- **Visit the town's locations** before dawn (12 Turns), getting past their obstacles and taking the loot (Chapter 4).
- **Choose on every roll**: hide behind your Mask, or let the Monster out (Chapter 3).
- **Watch Suspicion**: when it reaches the Limit, the whole town hunts you (Chapter 5).
- **Get out of town** with the goods — or run for it, and don't get forked (Chapter 6).





CHAPTER 2

The Entities

Eight Entities share the castle: Dracula, Frankenstein's Creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch, and Jekyll & Hyde. Each player picks one. No two players in a party play the same Entity.

Five Traits

Every Entity has five **traits**:

TRAIT	FOR
Brawn	Force, lifting, breaking, fighting
Nimble	Climbing, running, slipping free
Sly	Sneaking, hiding, stealing
Charm	Talking, bluffing, passing as human
Wits	Noticing, knowing, figuring things out

Each trait is rated as a die. **Every Entity has one each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4**, placed differently: what one Entity does with a d12, another fumbles with a d4. Jekyll & Hyde has two forms on one sheet, each with its own arrangement of the same five dice (he changes form with the Draught).

The Mask and the Monster

Every roll adds a second die to the trait die. You choose which: the **Mask d6**, passing as human, or the **Monster d10**, letting the monster out. The Monster is stronger, but if its number is higher than your trait die's, the Monster **shows**: Suspicion, the town's shared alarm, rises by 2 (Chapters 3 and 5). On a tie, or with the Mask, nothing shows. Every Entity has the same pair.

What Every Entity Has

- **A signature ability**, and a second ability chosen as its **Gift**.
- **A Weakness**: what the mob brings in a chase to make your trait die one size smaller (Chapter 6).
- **A Tell**: how it gives itself away. When it goes off, Suspicion +1 (Chapter 5).

Three Picks

Each Entity is premade, with three picks. Every pick has a marked default, so a new player can skip the choices. To pick at random, roll a d6: 1–2 the first option, 3–4 the second, 5–6 the third.

- **Gift:** one of three versions of the Entity's second ability.
- **Perk:** one of three edges, always on and free; each bends one rule in one situation.
- **Castle Duty:** one of six household jobs, the same six for every Entity, each with an edge where one kind of list item is found (below). No two Entities in a party take the same one. The Storyteller reads out the shopping list before anyone picks.

Charges

Every Entity has **3 charges**. One charge pays for one use of an ability. Every raid starts with all 3 (they refill at the castle, once a year); unspent ones are lost.

ABILITIES NEVER PASS AUTOMATICALLY

A signature or a Gift costs a charge each time you use it and does one of four things: a bigger trait die, a different trait, the Monster die without its Suspicion, or an approach of your own (the Draught changes form instead). Each still needs a roll (Chapter 3).

Castle Duties

Every Entity keeps one job at the castle and shops for one kind of item. **At a location whose list item is your Duty's kind, your trait die is one size bigger on your own rolls there**, the furniture's obstacle (Chapter 4) included, but never in a chase. That is the roll's one raise: no ability can raise it further (Chapter 3). Each Entity's entry gives its default Duty; if two defaults clash in a party, the player who chose later picks another or rolls a d6, rerolling any Duty already taken.

D6	DUTY	SHOPS FOR	WHERE IN TOWN	AT THE CASTLE
1	**Cook**	food and drink	the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar	Keeps the castle fed and knows every kitchen door
2	**Gardener**	plants and seeds	the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant	Knows what grows where, and what's poisonous
3	**Librarian**	books and paper	the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse	Reads the town's notices and signs
4	**Butler**	silver, china and linen	the silversmith, the china shop, the laundry	Knows how fine houses run, and where they keep the good spoons
5	**Handyman**	tools and hardware	the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter	Knows how locks and hinges work
6	**Tailor**	cloth and costumes	the draper, the tailor, the hatter	Keeps everyone's disguises in one piece

The Eight

The entries use terms from later chapters: rolls, Success, Cost, Trouble and Difficulty (Chapter 3); obstacles, watched and group, Turns, carrying and the way out (Chapter 4); Suspicion, the loud way, Tells and the Limit (Chapter 5); chases, the ground, the Lead, the lock-up and the final flight (Chapter 6). A new player can take the defaults and come back to them.

USING AN ENTRY

- **Spend before you roll.** A signature or a Gift can go on any roll in the same place (a location, the way out or the lock-up): yours, or a friend's, for your charge but not your action (Chapter 3). Not on a friend's roll in a local chase, and you can open an approach only on your own roll.
- **One raise per roll,** from any source, your Castle Duty's included. A d12 can't go higher, and a raise cancels a step down (Chapter 3).
- **Loud stays loud:** a trait the obstacle lists as its loud way is loud however you came to roll it (Chapter 5).
- **Perks aren't abilities:** they cost nothing, and one, the Ghost's Spectral, skips a roll.

Dracula



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d8** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d4**

Signature: Mesmerise 1 CHARGE

At a watched obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at a Difficulty 2 lower; Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He bends a mind with a look.*

Gift: Shape of the Night PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Bat** (default): Roll Nimble instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *He flits up to the window.*
- **Mist**: Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *If he shows, it's only fog.*

- **Wolf**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *The strength and speed of a wolf.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Hypnotic Eyes** (default): On Charm rolls, the Monster shows only if it beats your trait die by 2 or more.
- **Old Money**: A Cost on a Charm roll is never Suspicion +1.
- **Wall-Crawler**: In a chase you can always roll Nimble, whatever the ground.

Castle Duty (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen.

Weakness: Garlic. Always (from round 1): in any chase, from its first round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Every kitchen in town has some, and the mob knows it.*

Tell: No Reflection. *A shop window shows everyone but him.*

Frankenstein's Creature



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d10**

Signature: Brute Force 1 CHARGE

Roll Brawn instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *Stronger than any man, it breaks what others pick.*

Gift: Made, Not Born PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Mountain Stride** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He bounds over walls the way he crossed the glaciers.*
- **Hovel Watcher**: Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *He learned to watch unseen.*
- **Book-Learned**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *He taught himself from books.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Strong Back** (default): You carry a Huge piece alone.
- **Tireless**: Carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.
- **Built to Last**: You slip free from the lock-up on a Success or a Cost.

Castle Duty (default): Handyman, who shops for tools and hardware.

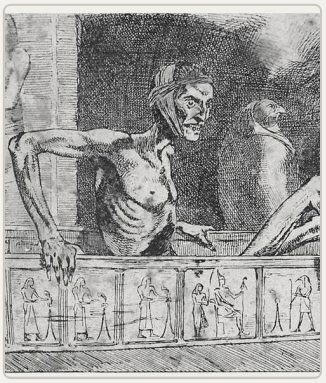
Weakness: Fire. Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone has to light the torches.*

Tell: Head and Shoulders. *He stands a head above the whole crowd, and no costume hides it.*

The Mummy



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Signature: Ancient Lore 1 CHARGE

Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It knew this trick three thousand years ago.*

Gift: Secrets of the Tomb PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Royal Bearing** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *They still bow to a pharaoh.*
- **Just a Costume**: Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *On festival night, who'd believe a real one?*
- **Old Curse**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *A muttered curse, and the lock gives.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Patience of Ages** (default): "Lose a Turn" is never your Cost.

- **Keeper of Treasures**: "Drop an item" is never your Cost.
- **Fear the Curse**: When you flee alone, the mob's Difficulty in your local chase is 1 lower. *Nobody wants to get too close.*

Castle Duty (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper.

Weakness: A Loose Thread. Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Once someone grabs a loose end, it all starts to unravel.*

Tell: Dust and Spice. *A trail of dust and a smell of old spices wherever it walks.*

The Werewolf



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d8**

Signature: Good Dog 1 CHARGE

Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *If the wolf shows, the crowd sees a very large dog.*

Gift: The Wolf Within PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Keen Nose** (default): Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It smells the way in.*
- **Through the Hedge**: At an obstacle that doesn't list Brawn, roll Brawn at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *It goes straight through.*
- **Howl**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *A howl that freezes the crowd for a moment.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

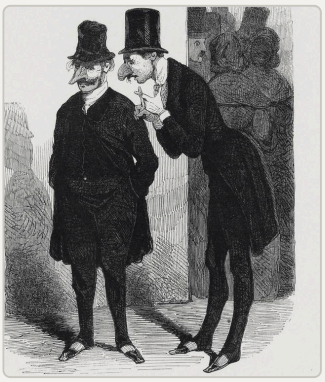
- **Night Runner** (default): When you flee alone, your local chase starts at Lead 2.
- **Shortcut**: The way out's Difficulty is 2 lower when you roll it.
- **Fetch**: Two edges. While you're at the way out, its Difficulty is 1 lower for whoever rolls it. A final flight you're in starts at Lead 3, not 2. *You know the way home.*

Castle Duty (default): Gardener, who shops for plants and seeds.

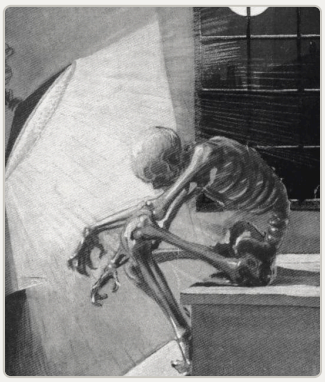
Weakness: Hounds. Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone lets the hunting dogs out.*

Tell: Eyebrows That Meet. *Brows that meet in the middle, and a little too much hair everywhere.*

The Invisible Man



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d12** · Charm **d6** · Wits **d10**

Signature: Unseen 1 CHARGE

Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *When the Monster shows, there's nothing to see.*

Gift: A Scientist's Tricks PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Through the Gap** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He slips through as the door swings shut.*
- **Poltergeist**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *Things move by themselves, and everyone looks the other way.*
- **Work It Out**: Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *A scientist's mind finds another way.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Out of Sight** (default): Trouble at a watched obstacle doesn't get you caught unless you, or anyone in the same place, carries loot or furniture. It still raises Suspicion. *They can't see you, but they can see a floating candlestick.*
- **Hidden Pockets**: Captured, you keep the loot you carry (not furniture).
- **Light Step**: The loud way costs you no Suspicion.

Castle Duty (default): Tailor, who shops for cloth and costumes.

Weakness: Flour. Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone throws a bag of flour, and there he is.*

Tell: Bandages and Goggles. *A wrapped head, dark goggles, a false nose, and a sneeze from nowhere.*

A Ghost



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d6**

Signature: Through the Wall 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Sly, roll Sly at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. Not while you carry loot or furniture: nothing you carry passes through. *It drifts in where there's no door.*

Gift: Haunting PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Chill** (default): Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *A sudden cold, and fingers fumble.*
- **Whisper**: Roll Charm instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *A voice in the ear.*
- **Fade**: Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *A trick of the light.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Spectral** (default): Group obstacles (the ones each Entity must get past for itself) don't stop you: no roll and no action, so you can still move or roll that Turn. Not while you carry loot or furniture.
- **Rattle**: The Monster showing on your roll is Suspicion +1, not +2. *Nobody takes rattling chains seriously.*
- **Already Dead**: Cornered in a local chase, you aren't captured: you're back where you were caught, still carrying what you had, and you lose your next Turn. If the Limit comes that round, you simply join the final flight.

Castle Duty (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen.

Weakness: Cold Iron. Always (from round 1): in any chase, from its first round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Horseshoes, railings, a poker from the fire: every street has some.*

Tell: Cold Spot. *Candles gutter and breath fogs wherever it drifts.*

A Witch



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d6** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Signature: Hedge Spell 1 CHARGE

Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher).

Gift: Witchcraft PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Broomstick** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *In over the rooftops, quiet as an owl.*
- **Black Cat**: Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). *Everyone blames the cat.*

- **A Potion for That**: Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *There's a potion for everything.*

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

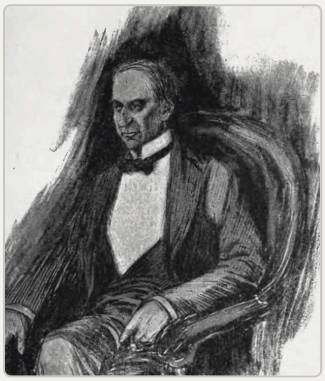
- **Familiar's Warning** (default): When you arrive somewhere that gets a Tell check (Chapter 5), alone or with others, a Tell goes off only if a second d6 also rolls 4–6. That covers everyone arriving with you. *The cat warns you.*
- **Fly by Night**: In a chase you can always roll Wits, whatever the ground.
- **Wise Woman**: A Cost on your Wits roll is never "lose a Turn".

Castle Duty (default): Cook, who shops for food and drink.

Weakness: Rowan. Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *A sprig of rowan, the old charm against witches: somebody's grandmother always has one.*

Tell: A Black Cat. *A black cat follows her everywhere and stares at people.*

Jekyll & Hyde



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Jekyll: Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d6** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d10**

Hyde: Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d6**

Signature: The Draught 1 CHARGE

Before one of your rolls, change form: Jekyll to Hyde or back (each has its own dice). The new form lasts until the next draught. Each raid starts with Jekyll. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, that roll stands and Hyde takes over straight after it, free, until a draught changes him back.

Gift: The Other Self PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Doctor's Bag** (default): Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher). *The right instrument for the job.*
- **Pillar of Society**: Take the Monster d10 as your second die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, that adds nothing. Anything else on the roll still raises Suspicion as usual (Chapter 3). On Jekyll's rolls, Hyde still takes over if the Monster shows. *A respectable doctor having a funny turn.*
- **Trample**: At an obstacle that doesn't list Brawn, roll Brawn at a Difficulty 2 lower; if it's watched, Trouble still gets you caught. Only you get past, but the way out still takes everyone and a rescue frees every captive (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. Your Brawn is a d4 as Jekyll, a d12 as Hyde.

Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Practised Hand** (default): Changing back to Jekyll costs no charge.
- **Steady Nerves**: On Jekyll's rolls, Hyde takes over only if the Monster beats your trait die by 2 or more. Beating it by 1 still shows: Suspicion +2.
- **Brute Strength**: As Hyde, carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.

Castle Duty (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper.

Weakness: A Familiar Face. Soon (from round 3): in any chase, from its third round to its end, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone in the mob recognises the good doctor.*

Tell: The Wrong Hand. *One hand a gentleman's, the other hairy and knotted.*



CHAPTER 3

Rolling the Dice

You roll only to get past an obstacle (Chapter 4; the way out and the lock-up are obstacles too) and in each round of a chase (Chapter 6): your trait die plus your Mask or Monster die, added together.

The Roll

1. **The obstacle sets the trait.** Each obstacle (Chapter 4) lists the traits that work, usually one or two. When it lists two, one is usually marked as the **loud way**: rolling that one raises Suspicion by 1, whatever the result (Chapter 5). To roll any other trait you need an ability (below). In a chase, the ground sets the trait instead (Chapter 6).
2. **Choose the second die:** the Mask d6 or the Monster d10. (Carrying furniture, or in the final flight, it must be the Monster: Chapters 4 and 6.)
3. **Roll both, add them,** and compare the total with the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

Results

- **Success:** the total is equal to the Difficulty or more. You do it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it, but the Storyteller picks one cost:
  - Suspicion +1.
  - Drop an item: one item of loot you carry, which the Storyteller picks. Never the loot this roll wins, and never furniture (dropping: Chapter 4).
  - Lose a Turn: you skip your next action (Chapter 4).
  - Your next roll's trait die is one size smaller.

  The Storyteller never picks a cost that costs nothing right then. For example, Suspicion +1 costs nothing on a roll that already raises Suspicion, because one roll raises it only once (Chapter 5).
- **Trouble:** 3 or more short. It doesn't happen, and Suspicion rises by 1. If the obstacle is watched (Chapter 4), you are also caught and must run: a local chase (Chapters 5 and 6).
- **Critical:** a Success where both dice show the same number. Outside a chase, you get back one charge you spent (never more than you started with). In a chase it counts as two Successes (Chapter 6).

In a chase, a result moves the Lead instead: a Cost costs nothing, and Trouble starts no new chase (Chapter 6).

The Monster Shows

If you rolled the Monster die and its number is **higher than your trait die's**, the Monster **shows**: **Suspicion +2**, whatever the result. A tie, or the Mask, shows nothing. *The monster did the work, and it showed.*

Abilities

Using an ability costs one charge. At zero charges you can still use one by **overdrawing**: it costs **Suspicion +2** instead of a charge. In the final flight it costs your Weakness instead: your trait die is one size smaller to the end of the flight (Chapter 6 says when you may).

Every ability but the Draught (Chapter 2) does one of four things:

- **Make your trait die one size bigger**, a **raise** (a d8 becomes a d10; a d12 can't go higher).
- **Use the ability's trait** instead of the one the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's: Chapter 6).
- **Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion:** if the Monster shows, that adds no Suspicion. Everything else on the roll still counts: Trouble, the loud way, a Cost

picked as Suspicion, an overdraw.

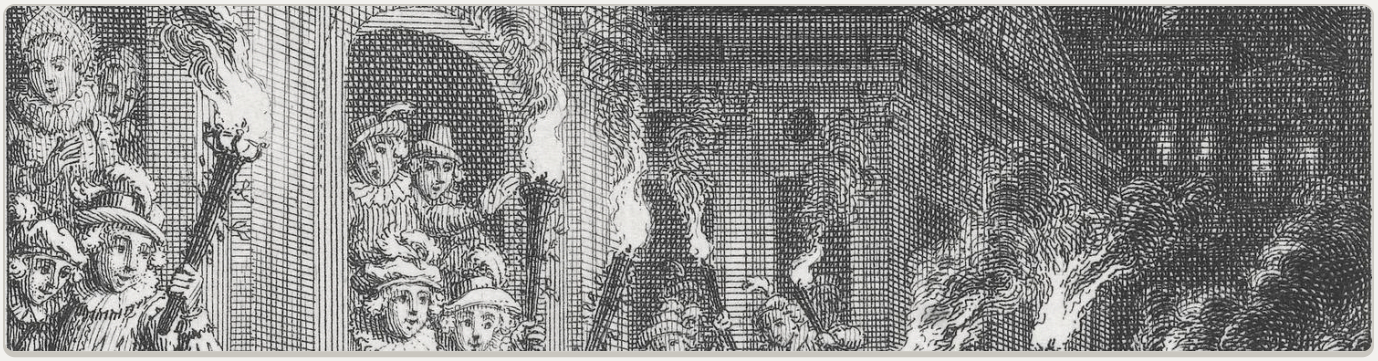
- **Open an approach of your own:** at an obstacle that doesn't list the ability's trait, roll that trait at a Difficulty 2 lower (a 10 becomes an 8). Never in a chase.
  - Any obstacle will do, not only a location's first one (its way in, Chapter 4).
  - The obstacle is still watched or not, as marked: Trouble at a watched one still gets you caught.
  - Only you get past it. It isn't beaten for the others: they must beat it themselves.
  - Two places work as usual. At the way out, your Success or Cost gets everyone out (Chapter 4). At the lock-up (Chapter 6), a rescuer's Success or Cost frees every captive, and a captive may open one to slip free.

Spend abilities before you roll.

- You can spend one on any Entity's roll at the same place as you (a location, the way out or the lock-up), even if you haven't got past the obstacles it has. In a local chase, only on your own roll (Chapter 6).
- Helping costs the charge, not your action.
- The roller always rolls its own dice: Brute Force spent on a friend's roll means the friend rolls its own Brawn.
- You can open an approach only on your own roll.

Several abilities may go on one roll, but only one of them may change the trait, and the roll takes **at most one raise**, from any source, Castle Duty included. A **step down** is anything that makes your trait die one size smaller: a Cost, your Weakness, carrying furniture (your Nimble only). Any number may apply. Net raises against steps down first: a d4 stepped down and raised stays a d4, and a d12 raised and stepped down stays a d12. Then apply the limits: nothing makes a die smaller than a d4, or bigger than a d12.





CHAPTER 4

The Raid

The raid happens on the town's yearly festival, Lantern Night, when everyone dresses up as a monster — which is why real ones can almost pass in the crowd. Dawn ends it.

The Shopping List

Before the raid, the Storyteller rolls the shopping list (Chapter 8; Chapter 9's towns have theirs): **4 items on Easy, 5 on Standard and Hard** (how hard the town is: Chapter 1). One or two are **essentials** (one on Easy, one or two on Standard, two on Hard); the rest are **extras**. To win, bring home every essential, with at most one extra missing (Chapter 7). Each item is one of six kinds (the "Shops for" column of the Castle Duties table, Chapter 2); its kind decides whose Castle Duty gives an edge at its location.

The Town

Every town is built from the same parts:

- **An obstacle:** the traits that work (one may be the loud way, Chapter 3) and a Difficulty. It may be marked **watched** (Trouble there gets you caught, Chapter 5) and **group** (below).
- **A location:** 1–3 obstacles, which you get past in order, guarding one list item (sometimes two, when two items share a place). Whoever gets past the last obstacle has the item in hand, with no extra action.
- **Two ways in:** a location's first obstacle comes in two versions (say, front door or back window). The party picks one the first time anyone tries the location, and everyone uses only that one there for the rest of the raid.
- **A watched location:** one with a watched obstacle, on either way in (the furniture's doesn't count). It gets a Tell check (Chapter 5). Being caught depends only on the obstacle you roll.
- **The way out** of town (below), always watched.
- **The lock-up**, where captives are held (Chapter 6), always watched.

A **place** is any of these: a location, the way out or the lock-up. An **item** is a thing on the shopping list; the items an Entity carries are its **loot**; the furniture or decor is a **piece** (below).

Turns

The night lasts **12 Turns**. The party starts at the edge of town, at the way out; entering the town needs no roll. Each Turn, every Entity takes one **action**:

- **Roll** at the next obstacle where it is.
- **Move** to any other place. A move takes one Turn (two when carrying furniture, below; a map may say otherwise).
- **Pick up** dropped items (below).
- **Wait.**

Entities act one at a time, in any order, and each result counts at once: an Entity who moves has arrived, and an obstacle one Entity beats is already beaten for the next to act. Several may try the same obstacle in one Turn; each try risks Trouble. The party may split up. *On Standard and Hard it usually should: there's rarely time to visit every place together.* **Dawn** comes when the 12th Turn ends: anyone still in town runs for it in the final flight (Chapter 6).

Once anyone beats an obstacle (a Success or a Cost), it stays beaten for the whole party, with two exceptions:

- A **group** obstacle (a crowd, a guard who checks everyone): each Entity who wants past rolls for itself.

- An obstacle someone got past with its own approach (Chapter 3): the others must still beat it.

If two or more Entities roll the same group obstacle in one Turn, they make one **group check** instead of acting one at a time: all declare their dice and abilities, then all roll at once. Each gets past on its own result. Suspicion rises only once for the whole check, by the biggest trigger among the rolls (Chapter 5).

Furniture

One piece of furniture or decor (Chapter 8) stands at one of the list's locations, behind one extra obstacle of its own, after the location's others. That obstacle's Difficulty is 2 higher than it would otherwise be (at most 12). Once that location's loot has been taken, whoever is past all its other obstacles may try for the piece. Bringing it home turns a Win into a **Grand Year** (Chapter 7).

Carrying

- A **Bulky** piece needs one carrier, a **Huge** piece two (Chapter 8 says which is which). A Huge piece can't go through an entrance a map marks small.
- While you carry a piece, you can't use the Mask, and your Nimble is one size smaller. Carrying loot doesn't do this.
- Carrying a piece, a move takes your action in two Turns in a row. After the first you're **between places**, at neither one. You arrive when you take your action in the second.
- Taking the piece, once you're past its obstacle, is free. Taking it back up after it's been set down is an action.
- From the Turn it's first taken, it raises Suspicion by 1 at the end of each Turn, even while set down. That stops when it's carried out of town, lost (the town takes it back when its carrier is captured, Chapter 6) or abandoned.
- You may **abandon** it at any time, free: it stays where it is, makes no more noise, and can't be taken again.

Loot. An Entity can carry any amount of loot, and can hand it to another Entity in the same place at any time, free (not once it's caught, until its chase ends, and never to a captive: Chapter 6).

Dropping and Picking Up

- You may drop your own loot, or a piece you carry, at any time, without using your action. Not once you're caught, until your chase ends (Chapter 6).
- It stays where you are: a location, the way out or the lock-up. Between places, it stays at the place you left; set down a piece there and you're back at that place too.
- Anyone at that place may pick up any number of dropped items, as their action for a Turn.

Getting Out

The way out is one watched obstacle: **Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way**, at Difficulty 6 on Easy, 8 on Standard and 10 on Hard. The party leaves together. One Entity rolls for everyone, but only when every Entity who isn't captured is at the way out. A Success or a Cost gets everyone out; a Cost here costs nothing. On Trouble, Suspicion rises and the roller is caught (Chapter 6); try again next Turn. Anyone still captured is left behind (Chapter 7).



CHAPTER 5

Suspicion

The whole town shares one Suspicion track, from 0 up to a **Limit**: 11 on Easy and Standard, 15 on Hard.

What Raises It

TRIGGER	SUSPICION	FROM A ROLL?
Trouble	+1	Yes
The Monster shows	+2	Yes
Taking the loud way	+1	Yes
A Cost chosen as Suspicion	+1	Yes
Overdraw	+2	Yes
A Tell goes off	+1	No
Furniture taken, each Turn (even set down)	+1	No

THE LOUD WAY

When an obstacle lists a loud way and you take it, Suspicion rises by 1, whatever the result. If an ability makes you roll the obstacle's loud trait (say, Brute Force where the loud way is Brawn), it's still loud. A trait the obstacle doesn't list is never loud.

ONE ROLL, ONE RISE

One roll raises Suspicion only once, by its biggest trigger (overdraw included): the loud way and the Monster showing on one roll make +2, not +3. Good results never lower it.

Tells

The first time anyone reaches a watched location (Chapter 4), the Storyteller makes a **Tell check**: roll a d6, and on **4–6** a Tell goes off. Each place is checked once a raid, for the whole party.

- The lock-up counts, but not a captive's arrival.
- The way out counts once anyone comes back to it.
- A watched furniture obstacle doesn't make its location watched.

The check is made once everyone moving there this Turn has arrived. If it goes off, pick one of the arrivals at random (number them and roll a die) and describe its Tell (Chapter 2). The only effect is **Suspicion +1**.

Getting Caught

Trouble at a watched obstacle gets the Entity caught, and a **local chase** starts (Chapter 6). Only the obstacle you rolled counts: Trouble at an unwatched one starts no chase, even in a watched location, but still raises Suspicion. Everyone with Trouble in one group check is caught and flees together.

At the Limit

When Suspicion reaches the Limit — or dawn comes with anyone still in town — **the hunt is on**: every Entity who isn't captured flees together in the **final flight** (Chapter 6). If the Limit comes during a local chase, that chase ends at once (even if a runner's own roll brought it there on purpose) and its runners join the flight, but anyone cornered in that same round is captured first and stays behind. From then on Suspicion stops. It never goes past the Limit; extra points are lost.



CHAPTER 6

Chases and Getting Forked

There are two kinds of chase. Caught during the raid, you run from a crowd: a **local chase**. When Suspicion reaches the Limit, or dawn comes with anyone still in town, the whole town turns out with pitchforks: the **final flight**.

The Lead

A chase is played in **rounds**, on a **Lead** track. The Lead starts low; you try to raise it to the escape number before the mob brings it to 0. The starting Lead, the escape number and the mob's Difficulty depend on the kind of chase (below). Each round:

1. **The ground.** The Storyteller rolls a d6 on the chase table (end of this chapter). The row names two traits that work this round, for everyone in the chase.
2. **Choose.** Each Entity in the chase picks one of those two traits, and its second die. In a local chase that is the Mask or the Monster (no Mask while carrying furniture). In the final flight it is the Monster only.
3. **Abilities.** Spend them before rolling, as in Chapter 3. An ability that changes the trait rolls its trait instead of the ground's. Opening an approach never works in a chase, and Castle Duty gives no raise.
4. **Roll** against the mob's Difficulty.
5. **Move the Lead.** Fleeing alone, your result moves it:
   - **Success:** Lead +1 (a Critical: +2).
   - **Cost:** no change.
   - **Trouble:** Lead –1.

   Fleeing with others, it moves once for the round, by the majority rule (below).

Reach the escape number and you're clear. Reach 0 and you're **cornered**: captured in a local chase, forked in the final flight.

A chase roll only moves the Lead. A Cost brings no Storyteller's Cost, and Trouble starts no new chase.

Suspicion in a chase. In a local chase it still rises as usual: Trouble +1, the Monster showing +2, an overdraw +2, once per roll, by its biggest trigger. When several flee together, it rises once a round, by the biggest trigger among all their rolls. As it rises, the local mob gets harder (below). In the final flight Suspicion has stopped (Once the Hunt Is On).

Your Weakness

Once the mob brings your Weakness, your trait die is one size smaller to the end of the chase. Each Weakness (Chapter 2) says when the mob brings it:

- **Always:** from the first round of any chase (Dracula, a Ghost).
- **Soon:** from the third round of any chase (everyone else).

Count rounds from 1 in each chase. The final flight is a new chase, even for an Entity who joins it from a local chase. In the final flight, an overdraw can bring your Weakness in sooner (Once the Hunt Is On).

The Local Chase

When you're caught (Trouble at a watched obstacle, Chapter 5), you run:

- **Lead:** starts at **1**. You escape at **4**.
- **The mob's Difficulty: 8 plus half the Suspicion**, rounded down, at most 12. Work it out again at the start of every round: the chase can raise Suspicion. (Suspicion 5: 8 + 2 = 10.)
- **Abilities:** on your own roll only. Nobody else can spend a charge on your roll in a local chase, not even a fellow runner.

- **What you carry:** you can't drop or hand over anything until the chase ends.
- **Time:** the whole chase, however many rounds it takes, happens inside the Turn it started. Escape, and you're back where you were caught, with that Turn used up.
- **Caught together:** Entities caught in the same group check flee together on one shared Lead, moved by the majority rule (below), and are captured together if cornered.
- **The Limit:** if Suspicion reaches the Limit during the chase, the chase ends at once and the runners join the final flight. Anyone cornered that same round is captured first (Chapter 5).

Captured

Cornered in a local chase, you are **captured**, and the town takes back what you were carrying, furniture included: it's gone for the night, and nobody can take it again. You are held at the town's **lock-up**: a place of its own, like a location, one move from anywhere unless the map says otherwise, and always watched.

While held, you can't pick up or be handed anything. You can still spend charges on any roll at the lock-up: your own, a rescuer's or another captive's.

	RESCUE	SLIPPING FREE
Who rolls	Anyone who isn't held, at the lock-up (getting there is a move)	The captive, once per Turn, from the Turn after its capture
Traits	Sly, or Brawn the loud way	Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way
Difficulty	The lock-up's: 10	The lock-up's: 10
Success	Every captive there is free	You're free
Cost	Every captive there is free (the Storyteller picks a Cost as usual)	Nothing happens
Trouble	Suspicion +1, and the rescuer is caught: a local chase	Suspicion +1, but no chase
Then	The freed act again next Turn, from the lock-up	You act again next Turn, from the lock-up

The lock-up is always watched, so abilities that need a watched obstacle (Dracula's Mesmerise) work on both. A rescue frees only the captives held at that moment: anyone captured later needs a new rescue.

Left behind: anyone still held when the others leave town, by the way out or by escaping the final flight, is left behind (Chapter 7).

The Final Flight

At the Limit, or at dawn with anyone still in town, every Entity who isn't captured flees together, wherever they are.

- **Lead:** starts at **2**. The party escapes at **5** (**6** on Hard).
- **The mob's Difficulty:** 10 on Easy, 11 on Standard and Hard, however many flee.
- **Dice:** the Monster only; the Mask is off (Once the Hunt Is On).
- **Abilities:** on anyone's roll. You all flee together.
- **The Lead** moves by the majority rule (below).
- **What you carry:** anything dropped in the flight is left in town.

THE MAJORITY RULE

Whenever several Entities share a chase (the final flight, or a local chase begun by one group check), everyone in it rolls each round, in any order the party likes. Then count the Successes (a Critical counts as two) and the Trouble. Costs count for neither.

- Successes ahead by 1: Lead +1. Ahead by 2 or more: Lead +2.
- Trouble ahead by 1: Lead –1. Ahead by 2 or more: Lead –2.
- Level: the Lead stays.

Example: a Success, a Critical, a Cost and a Trouble make 3 Successes to 1 Trouble: Lead +2.

Escape, and everyone in the flight is home with what they carry. Anyone still in the lock-up is left behind. **Cornered**, and the party is **forked**: the monsters in the flight are killed, and the year's result is Forked (Chapter 7).

Once the Hunt Is On

From the moment the hunt is on, when the final flight begins:

- Suspicion stops. Nothing raises it any more.
- **The Mask is off.** Everyone rolls the Monster die.
- **Overdraw** (Chapter 3) costs your Weakness instead of Suspicion: from your own next roll to the end of the flight, your trait die is one size smaller. If you overdraw on the roll of someone who rolls before you in a round, your own roll that round already takes it.

- You can overdraw only once per flight, and not at all while your Weakness is in play, however it came. (An Always Weakness is in play from round 1, so Dracula and a Ghost can't overdraw in the flight.)

In a local chase none of this applies: overdraw costs Suspicion +2 as usual.

The Chase Table

D6	THE GROUND	TRAITS THAT WORK
1	**The crowded square.** Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through.	Sly, Charm
2	**Back alleys.** Duck, dodge, double back.	Nimble, Sly
3	**The market stalls.** Overturn a cart, vault a stall.	Brawn, Nimble
4	**Over the rooftops.** Climb, jump, find a way down.	Nimble, Wits
5	**The festival parade.** Join in: you're in costume, after all.	Charm, Sly
6	**A dead end.** Break through, or think fast.	Brawn, Wits

Every row offers a trait other than Nimble.





CHAPTER 7

How the Year Went

When the party is out of town — or the mob has the last word — look at what came home.

An item, or the piece, is **home** if an Entity who got out of town, by the way out or by escaping the final flight, carries it.

RESULT	WHEN
Grand Year	A Win, and the piece of furniture or decor came home too
Win	Every essential home, and no more than one extra missing
Partial	Not a Win, but at least half the list home: 2 of 4 items, 3 of 5. A missing essential makes it a Partial at best
Bust	Less than half the list home: 0–1 of 4, 0–2 of 5
Forked	Cornered in the final flight: the raid is lost, whatever came home

Left Behind

Work out the result first. Then drop it one step for each Entity left behind in the lock-up: a Grand Year becomes a Win, a Win a Partial, a Partial a Bust. Two left behind drop it two steps. It never drops below Bust.

The Epilogue

The result decides the epilogue — how the castle's year goes — and nothing else. Nothing carries over to the next raid, unless you play the optional campaign rules below. Read the result's line from the first table below. Then, unless the result is Forked, read a line from the second table for each kind of item that didn't come home: once per kind, however many items of that kind are missing.

RESULT	THE YEAR
Grand Year	A year of plenty. The new piece goes in the great hall, and everyone pretends it was always there.
Win	Full larders, warm fires. The castle creaks happily through another year.
Partial	The castle gets by, just. Someone has to sleep in the draughty tower.
Bust	A long, thin year, and a lot of arguing about whose fault it was.
Forked	The town tells the story for years. Next Lantern Night, the bells ring a little louder.

MISSING	WHAT THE CASTLE WENT WITHOUT
Food and drink	Turnip soup every night until spring.
Plants and seeds	Nothing grows but nettles, and the nettles win.
Books and paper	Nobody knows what the town is saying, or what day it is.
Silver, china and linen	Dinner is served on old coffin lids.
Tools and hardware	Every door in the castle creaks, sticks or falls off.
Cloth and costumes	Next year's disguises are held together with string and hope.

OPTIONAL: CAMPAIGN PLAY

For groups who play several raids with the same castle:

- Each piece of furniture or decor brought home, whatever the year's result, becomes a **castle upgrade**.
- At the start of each later raid, the players give each upgrade to one Entity in the party. Each upgrade gives that Entity **one extra charge** that raid, as part of its starting number: with one upgrade it starts with 4, and a Critical can refill it up to 4 (Chapter 3). One Entity may take more than one upgrade.
- The castle holds **three upgrades** at most. A fourth piece replaces one of them; the players choose which (all upgrades work the same).
- Nothing else carries over. An Entity forked or left behind is back at the castle for the next raid, and the Entities themselves never change.

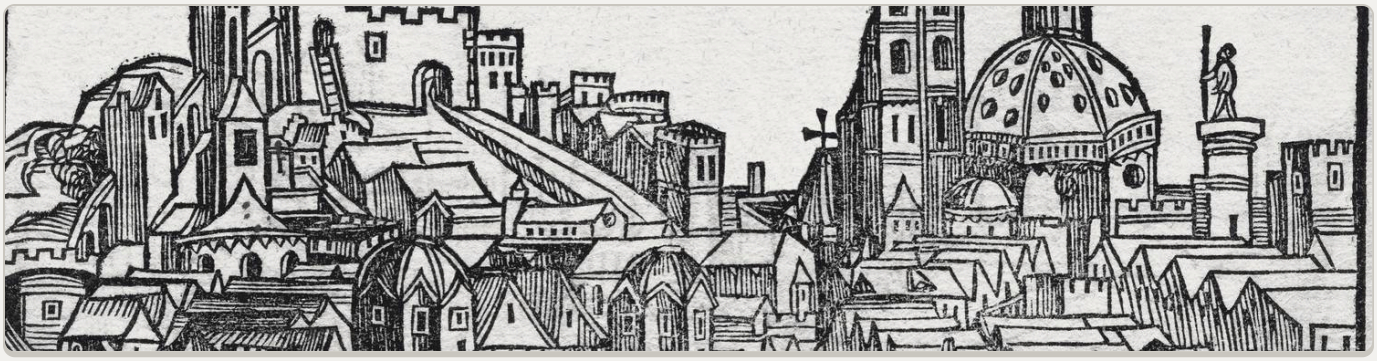


PART TWO

Running the Game

For the Storyteller: building a town, setting its difficulty, and running the villagers and the mob.





CHAPTER 8

Building a Town

Every raid is on a new town. There are three ways to build one, all from the same parts — obstacles, locations, the way out and the lock-up.

Three Ways

- **A premade town:** a fixed set of locations and obstacles, ready to run. Chapter 9 has three, one each for Easy, Standard and Hard, each with its map.
- **Your own town:** draw your own town on a map, choose its locations, and build each one by hand with the Building a Location by Hand box below (or roll any part of it). Your map may make some moves take two Turns, and mark some entrances small, even the way out (then a Huge piece can't be carried out of town).
- **The random tables:** roll the locations, obstacles, loot and villagers. A ceiling on the hardest obstacles keeps a rolled town as hard as its choice of Easy, Standard or Hard promises (Rolling a Town, step 4).

Rolling a Town

Build a rolled town in this order:

1. **Choose Easy, Standard or Hard** (its table is below).
2. **Roll the shopping list**, before the players make their picks: they hear it first (Chapter 2).
3. **Roll the furniture** and the location it stands at.
4. **Place the locations and roll their obstacles** (the four steps below).
5. **Roll the Lantern Night custom.**

Every town also has **the way out** (Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way; Chapter 4) and **the lock-up** (Chapter 6), the same in every town, each one move from any location. Only their Difficulties come from the Easy, Standard or Hard table. Roll villagers as you need them.

Placing the locations and their obstacles:

1. **Locations.** Each item on the list gets a location at one of the three places its kind is found (listed under its kind in the shopping table below).
   - Roll a d3, or pick: 1 is the first place listed, 2 the second, 3 the third.
   - One item per place. If the place is taken, roll again or pick another.
   - If a kind has more items than places, two of them share a place: one location, guarding both items.
2. **How many obstacles.** For each location, roll a d20 on the first row of the table below: one, two or three obstacles, which you get past in order. The two ways in count as one: the first obstacle.
3. **Each obstacle.** Roll three dice for each:
   - a d20 on the obstacle table: what it is, and its quiet and loud ways;
   - a d20 on the Difficulty row of the table below;
   - a d10 on the Watched row of the table below.

   Roll the first obstacle twice, once for each way in. If the second way in's quiet way is the same trait as the first's, roll the obstacle table again until it differs. A later obstacle may repeat one of the ways in (two shuttered windows are fine). Roll one more obstacle at the furniture's location. It stands after that location's last obstacle, and its Difficulty is 2 higher than rolled, at most 12.
4. **The ceiling.** A town may have one Difficulty 12 (two on Hard). Keep the first you roll. Reroll the Difficulty d20 of each later one until it isn't 12. The furniture's obstacle counts by its d20 roll, before the +2: a rolled 10 that becomes 12 doesn't count; a rolled 12 does.

ROLL	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Obstacles at a location (d20)	1–10: one · 11–18: two · 19–20: three	1–6: one · 7–15: two · 16–20: three	1–4: one · 5–13: two · 14–20: three
Difficulty (d20)	1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12	1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12	1–8: 8 · 9–17: 10 · 18–20: 12
Watched (d10)	watched on 1–4	watched on 1–5	watched on 1–6

The Obstacle Table

The quiet way gets past without a fuss; the loud way works too, but Suspicion rises by 1 whatever the result (Chapter 5). At a *group* obstacle, each Entity who wants past rolls for itself (Chapter 4).

D20	OBSTACLE	QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY
1	A heavy cellar trapdoor	Brawn	—
2	A tug-of-war across the lane *(group)*	Brawn	—
3	A cart blocking the alley	Brawn	Nimble (*scramble over the load*)
4	A bolted back gate	Brawn (*lift it off its hinges*)	Charm (*shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it*)
5	A high garden wall	Nimble	Brawn (*through the gate, lock and all*)
6	A shuttered window	Nimble	Brawn (*force the shutters*)
7	The rooftops *(group)*	Nimble	—
8	A rickety drainpipe	Nimble	—
9	A locked front door	Sly (*pick the lock*)	Brawn (*kick it in*)
10	A nosy neighbour at her window	Sly	Wits (*a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!"*)
11	A crowded shop floor *(group)*	Sly	—
12	A muddy yard full of geese	Sly	Nimble (*run for it, honking*)
13	The shopkeeper behind the counter	Charm	Sly (*snatch it from under her nose*)
14	A guard dog	Charm (*a biscuit and a pat*)	Nimble (*outrun it, barking*)
15	A doorman checking invitations	Charm	Wits (*a forged invitation that fools nobody for long*)
16	Children in costumes who want a closer look *(group)*	Charm	—
17	A locked strongbox	Wits (*work out the catch*)	Charm (*sweet-talk the clerk into opening it*)
18	A dark, cluttered back room	Wits	Sly (*rummage through everything*)
19	The night watchman on his round	Wits (*time his round*)	—
20	A maze of festival stalls *(group)*	Wits	—

BUILDING A LOCATION BY HAND

For your own town, or when you'd rather pick than roll:

- **Traits:** one or two. With two, usually one is quiet and one loud (the loud way costs Suspicion +1 whatever the result).
- **Difficulty:** 6, 8, 10 or 12 (Chapter 3). Aim for the mix the Easy, Standard or Hard table gives, and keep to the ceiling (Rolling a Town, step 4).
- **Watched or not:** Trouble at a watched obstacle gets an Entity caught.
- **Group or not:** at a group obstacle each Entity who wants past rolls for itself.
- **Two ways in:** two versions of the first obstacle, with different quiet traits.

Easy, Standard or Hard

Choose Easy, Standard or Hard. The choice sets these numbers:

	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Shopping list (essentials)	4 (1)	5 (1–2)	5 (2)
Obstacle Difficulties the d20 gives (6 · 8 · 10 · 12)	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	0 · 40 · 45 · 15%
Suspicion Limit	11	11	15
The final flight: escape at Lead	5	5	6
The way out: Difficulty	6	8	10
The final flight: mob Difficulty	10	11	11
The lock-up: Difficulty	10	10	10

The same on Easy, Standard and Hard:

- 3 charges per Entity, 12 Turns, overdraw Suspicion +2.
- Local chase: Lead starts at 1, escape at 4; the mob is 8 plus half the Suspicion, rounded down, at most 12.
- Final flight: Lead starts at 2.
- In a rolled town no entrance is small (Chapter 4).

The Shopping List

For each item, roll two d6: the first for its kind, the second for the item. If you roll an item already on the list, roll both dice again.

The essentials are the first items you roll: one on Easy, two on Hard. On Standard, roll any die: odd, one essential; even, two.

Only the kind matters to the rules. It decides where the item can be (Rolling a Town) and which Castle Duty gets its edge at its location (Chapter 2).

D6	KIND	THE ITEM (SECOND D6)
1	**Food and drink** *the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar*	**1** a wheel of strong cheese · **2** a side of bacon · **3** a cask of red wine ("for the guests") · **4** a sack of flour · **5** a jar of honey · **6** the wedding cake in the shop window
2	**Plants and seeds** *the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant*	**1** seed potatoes · **2** a pot of nightshade (purely ornamental) · **3** rose bushes for the graveyard · **4** turnip seed for next year's lanterns · **5** a crate of lilies · **6** mushroom spawn for the cellar
3	**Books and paper** *the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse*	**1** this week's newspapers · **2** black-edged writing paper · **3** a cookbook "for the guests" · **4** ink and sealing wax · **5** an almanac with next year's moons · **6** a book of etiquette
4	**Silver, china and linen** *the silversmith, the china shop, the laundry*	**1** the silver spoons · **2** a tea service · **3** bed linen · **4** a lace tablecloth · **5** a pair of candlesticks · **6** a gravy boat
5	**Tools and hardware** *the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter*	**1** a box of nails · **2** a new lock for the dungeon · **3** hinges that creak properly · **4** a lamp and a can of oil · **5** a coil of rope · **6** a length of good chain
6	**Cloth and costumes** *the draper, the tailor, the hatter*	**1** a bolt of black velvet · **2** bandages, lots · **3** a top hat · **4** a new cape · **5** knitting wool · **6** boots in a very large size

The Furniture

1. Roll a d6 on the table below for the piece. Decor counts as furniture for every rule.
2. Choose the list item it stands with, or roll for it: number the list's items from 1 and roll a d6, rolling again on a number with no item. The piece stands at that item's location.
3. It stands behind one extra obstacle, after that location's last (Rolling a Town, step 3).

Its size says how many carry it: Bulky one, Huge two (Carrying, Chapter 4).

D6	THE PIECE	SIZE
1	A wingback armchair	Bulky
2	A gilt mirror	Bulky
3	A suit of armour	Bulky
4	A stuffed bear	Bulky
5	A grandfather clock	Huge
6	A four-poster bed	Huge

Lantern Night

On the festival night, everyone dresses up as a monster and carries a lantern to keep the real ones away. Every town keeps it its own way: roll a d6 or pick a custom for each town. Customs are flavour, not rules.

D6	LOCAL CUSTOM
1	Turnip lanterns in every window.
2	A costume parade through the square at midnight.
3	A masked ball at the mayor's house.
4	Pies left on doorsteps "for the wanderers".
5	A bonfire in the square, and a straw monster burned at dawn.
6	Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

The Villagers

Whenever a watched obstacle needs a face, or a Cost needs someone to cause it, roll a d6 for who it is and another d6 for what they're doing. Villagers are flavour: they don't change an obstacle's traits or Difficulty. Roll them as you need them, or a couple before play (each of Chapter 9's towns lists two).

D6	WHO	WHAT THEY'RE DOING
1	The baker's wife	Looking for a lost cat
2	The night watchman	Tipsy from the cider
3	A gang of children	Judging the costume contest
4	The vicar	Carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade"
5	The mayor, in his best costume	Gossiping, loudly
6	Old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before	Practising the bells

Running the Villagers and the Mob

Villagers and witnesses. Everyone in town is in costume and in a good mood, and they see what they expect to see. A watched obstacle means someone is looking; if it isn't already a person, give them a face (one of a premade town's villagers, or a roll). Play the town busy and cheerful, until it isn't.

Choosing Costs. Pick the one that hurts most right now, but never one that costs nothing (Chapter 3). A lost Turn bites near dawn, a smaller die before a hard roll, "drop an item" when the roller carries loot (it drops its own, Chapter 3), Suspicion +1 near the Limit. At the way out a Cost has no effect: everyone still leaves, free (Chapter 4), so there's nothing to pick. Always say what happened: the baker's wife looks twice.

Suspicion. Keep the track where everyone can see it, and let the town's mood follow it: whispers, then pointing, then torches.

The mob. In every chase, roll the ground on the chase table each round, and describe it. Once the hunt is on, the mob is like the weather: always there, always closer. When a Weakness comes into play (Chapter 6), make it a moment.

The lock-up. Capture is a setback, not an ending. The captive can try to slip free once each Turn after the one it was caught in, and the others can come for it (Chapter 6). Keep the captive's player, and anyone else waiting, busy: let them voice a jailer or a villager.

Pacing. Count the Turns aloud, and warn when three are left. Early on, give each player a job that suits their monster, and steer a new player toward a Difficulty 8 obstacle first. Furniture always costs Suspicion: +1 at the end of every Turn from the one it's taken until it leaves town, and a carried move takes two Turns, so even a piece carried straight to the way out adds at least 1, and usually 2. Warn the party if that would reach the Limit. A raid should fit in an hour or two; roll a town before the session (it takes about half an hour).





CHAPTER 9

Three Towns

THREE TOWNS READY TO RAID, ONE EACH FOR EASY, Standard and Hard, each with a map and everything needed to run it.

Each location's rows run in order: its two ways in (picked the first time anyone tries the location, then kept for the raid), then each "Then". The furniture's obstacle is already 2 harder. It comes last, marked "for the piece".

EASY Puddlecombe

A sleepy village that has never had a real monster.

Lantern Night: Pies left on doorsteps "for the wanderers".

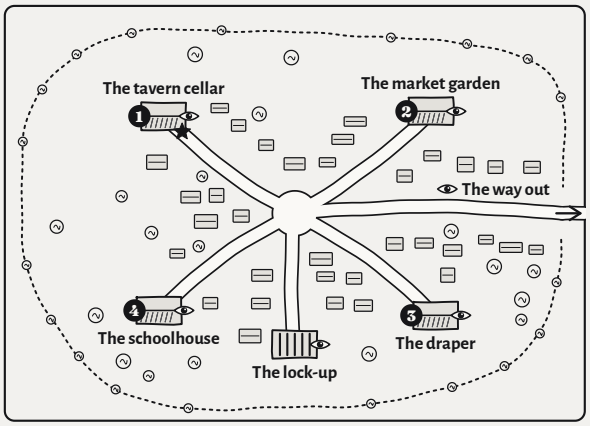
The shopping list (4 items):

1. **A wheel of strong cheese** (essential)
2. Seed potatoes
3. Knitting wool
4. An almanac with next year's moons

The furniture: a stuffed bear (Bulky: one carrier), at the tavern cellar (1).

Villagers: the baker's wife (looking for a lost cat); the night watchman (tipsy from the cider).

Easy: Suspicion Limit 11 · Difficulty: the way out 6, the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 10, Lead 2, escape at 5.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE		QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 **The tavern cellar: a wheel of strong cheese** (food and drink) · **essential**				
WAY IN	**A locked front door** *watched*	Sly (*pick the lock*)	Brawn (*kick it in*)	8
OR	**A heavy cellar trapdoor** *watched*	Brawn	—	8
THEN	**A dark, cluttered back room**	Wits	Sly (*rummage through everything*)	6
THEN	**A guard dog** *for the piece*	Charm (*a biscuit and a pat*)	Nimble (*outrun it, barking*)	10
2 **The market garden: seed potatoes** (plants and seeds)				
WAY IN	**A high garden wall**	Nimble	Brawn (*through the gate, lock and all*)	8
OR	**A muddy yard full of geese**	Sly	Nimble (*run for it, honking*)	6
THEN	**The night watchman on his round** *watched*	Wits (*time his round*)	—	8
3 **The draper: knitting wool** (cloth and costumes)				
WAY IN	**The shopkeeper behind the counter** *watched*	Charm	Sly (*snatch it from under her nose*)	8
OR	**A shuttered window**	Nimble	Brawn (*force the shutters*)	10
4 **The schoolhouse: an almanac with next year's moons** (books and paper)				
WAY IN	**A bolted back gate**	Brawn (*lift it off its hinges*)	Charm (*shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it*)	8
OR	**A rickety drainpipe**	Nimble	—	10
THEN	**Children in costumes who want a closer look** *(group)* *watched*	Charm	—	8

READING THE TOWN PAGES

- *Watched:* Trouble there gets you caught. *(group):* each Entity rolls for itself. The loud way works too, at Suspicion +1 whatever the result. The kind in brackets is what one Castle Duty shops for.
- Try the furniture's obstacle once that location's loot has been taken.
- The way out (Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way) and the lock-up (Sly, or Brawn the loud way; Nimble too to slip free) are always watched.
- On the map, an eye marks a watched location (one with a watched obstacle besides the furniture's): the first time anyone arrives, make a Tell check (Chapter 5). A star marks the furniture. Any move takes one Turn (two carrying furniture).
- The Lantern Night custom and the villagers are colour: the villagers are the faces at watched obstacles.

STANDARD Thistlewick *A market town proud of its festival.*

Lantern Night: A costume parade through the square at midnight.

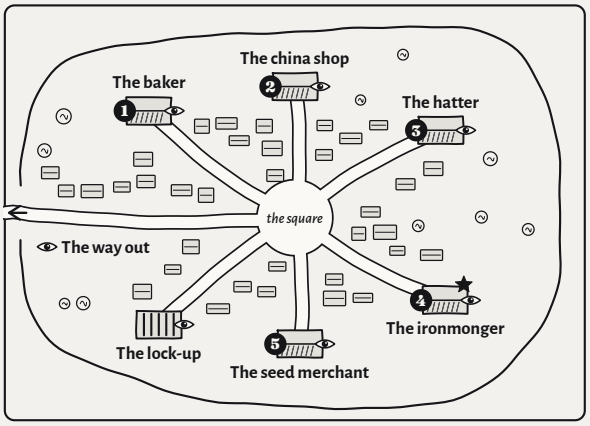
The shopping list (5 items):

1. **The wedding cake in the shop window** (essential)
2. **A tea service** (essential)
3. A top hat
4. A coil of rope
5. Turnip seed for next year's lanterns

The furniture: a gilt mirror (Bulky: one carrier), at the ironmonger (4).

Villagers: the mayor, in his best costume (judging the costume contest); the vicar (carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade").

Standard: Suspicion Limit 11 · Difficulty: the way out 8, the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 11, Lead 2, escape at 5.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE		QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1 **The baker: the wedding cake in the shop window** (food and drink) · **essential**				
WAY IN	**A crowded shop floor *(group)* *watched***	Sly	—	8
OR	**A shuttered window**	Nimble	Brawn (*force the shutters*)	8
THEN	**The shopkeeper behind the counter *watched***	Charm	Sly (*snatch it from under her nose*)	8
2 **The china shop: a tea service** (silver, china and linen) · **essential**				
WAY IN	**A locked front door**	Sly (*pick the lock*)	Brawn (*kick it in*)	8
OR	**A bolted back gate *watched***	Brawn (*lift it off its hinges*)	Charm (*shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it*)	10
THEN	**A dark, cluttered back room**	Wits	Sly (*rummage through everything*)	8
3 **The hatter: a top hat** (cloth and costumes)				
WAY IN	**A nosy neighbour at her window *watched***	Sly	Wits (*a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!"*)	8
OR	**The rooftops *(group)***	Nimble	—	10
4 **The ironmonger: a coil of rope** (tools and hardware)				
WAY IN	**A cart blocking the alley**	Brawn	Nimble (*scramble over the load*)	6
OR	**A high garden wall**	Nimble	Brawn (*through the gate, lock and all*)	8
THEN	**A locked strongbox *watched***	Wits (*work out the catch*)	Charm (*sweet-talk the clerk into opening it*)	8
THEN	**A guard dog *watched* *for the piece***	Charm (*a biscuit and a pat*)	Nimble (*outrun it, barking*)	10
5 **The seed merchant: turnip seed for next year's lanterns** (plants and seeds)				
WAY IN	**A maze of festival stalls *(group)***	Wits	—	8
OR	**A muddy yard full of geese**	Sly	Nimble (*run for it, honking*)	6
THEN	**The night watchman on his round *watched***	Wits (*time his round*)	—	10

HARD **Gallowsmere** *A walled town that remembers last year.*

Lantern Night: Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

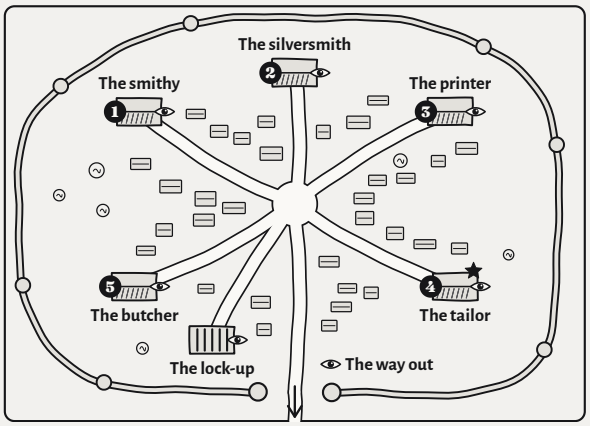
The shopping list (5 items):

1. **A new lock for the dungeon** (essential)
2. **The silver spoons** (essential)
3. Black-edged writing paper
4. Bandages, lots
5. A side of bacon

The furniture: a suit of armour (Bulky: one carrier), at the tailor (4).

Villagers: old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before (practising the bells); a gang of children (gossiping, loudly).

Hard: Suspicion Limit 15 · Difficulty: the way out 10, the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 11, Lead 2, escape at 6.



LOCATION · OBSTACLE		QUIET WAY	LOUD WAY	DIFFICULTY
1	**The smithy: a new lock for the dungeon** (tools and hardware) · **essential**			
WAY IN	**A bolted back gate** *watched*	Brawn (*lift it off its hinges*)	Charm (*shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it*)	**10**
OR	**A high garden wall** *watched*	Nimble	Brawn (*through the gate, lock and all*)	**8**
THEN	**The night watchman on his round** *watched*	Wits (*time his round*)	—	**10**
2	**The silversmith: the silver spoons** (silver, china and linen) · **essential**			
WAY IN	**A locked front door** *watched*	Sly (*pick the lock*)	Brawn (*kick it in*)	**10**
OR	**A shuttered window** *watched*	Nimble	Brawn (*force the shutters*)	**8**
THEN	**A guard dog** *watched*	Charm (*a biscuit and a pat*)	Nimble (*outrun it, barking*)	**8**
THEN	**A locked strongbox**	Wits (*work out the catch*)	Charm (*sweet-talk the clerk into opening it*)	**10**
3	**The printer: black-edged writing paper** (books and paper)			
WAY IN	**A nosy neighbour at her window** *watched*	Sly	Wits (*a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!"*)	**8**
OR	**The rooftops** *(group)*	Nimble	—	**10**
THEN	**A dark, cluttered back room**	Wits	Sly (*rummage through everything*)	**8**
4	**The tailor: bandages, lots** (cloth and costumes)			
WAY IN	**A doorman checking invitations** *watched*	Charm	Wits (*a forged invitation that fools nobody for long*)	**10**
OR	**A rickety drainpipe**	Nimble	—	**8**
THEN	**A crowded shop floor** *(group)* *watched*	Sly	—	**10**
THEN	**A heavy cellar trapdoor** *for the piece*	Brawn	—	**12**
5	**The butcher: a side of bacon** (food and drink)			
WAY IN	**A muddy yard full of geese** *watched*	Sly	Nimble (*run for it, honking*)	**8**
OR	**A cart blocking the alley** *watched*	Brawn	Nimble (*scramble over the load*)	**10**
THEN	**The shopkeeper behind the counter** *watched*	Charm	Sly (*snatch it from under her nose*)	**10**
THEN	**A tug-of-war across the lane** *(group)*	Brawn	—	**12**

An Example of Play

Four players raid Thistlewick: Dracula, the Witch, Frankenstein's Creature and the Werewolf, with their default picks (Butler, Cook, Handyman and Gardener). Suspicion starts at 0; the Limit is 11.

Turn 1. The party splits. The Witch and the Werewolf head for the baker, where the Witch's Cook Duty gives her an edge; Dracula and the Creature take the china shop, where Dracula's Butler Duty gives him the same edge. Both count as watched (the china shop for its back gate, though they'll use the front door), so the Storyteller makes a **Tell check** at each, a d6 that sets off one arriving Entity's Tell on 4–6: a 2 and a 1, no Tells. (At the baker, the Witch's Familiar's Warning would have needed a second 4–6 too.)

Turn 2. At the baker, the party takes the shuttered window. The Werewolf rolls Nimble d12 with the **Mask**: 10 + 4 = 14 against 8, a Success. The window is open for both of them now, so the Witch goes on to the shopkeeper (Charm, 8, watched). Her Charm d8 is a d10 here (her Duty's raise), and she lets the **Monster** out for the bigger die: 1 + 4 = 5.

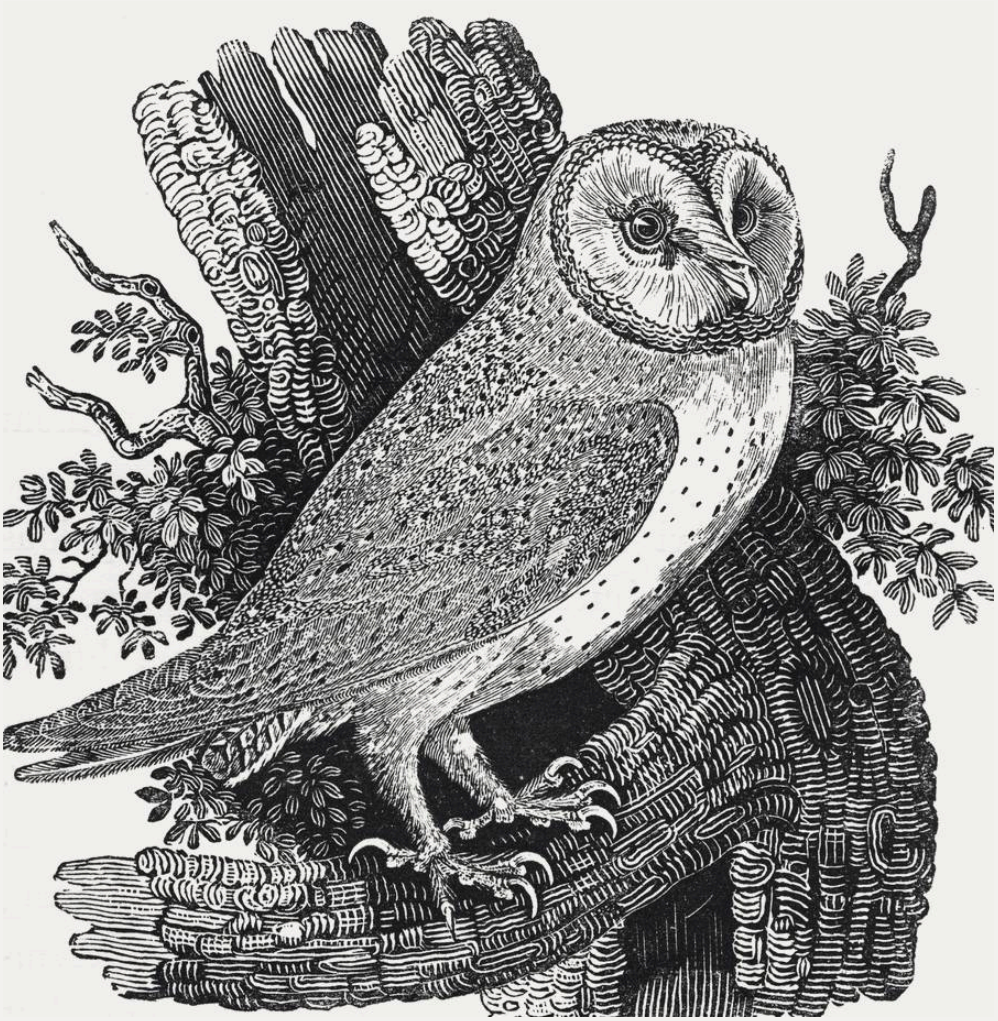
That is 3 short, **Trouble**, and the Monster's 4 beat her trait die's 1, so it showed. One roll, one rise: Suspicion goes up by the bigger trigger, to 2. The shopkeeper was watching, so the Witch is caught.

She runs. Her **Lead** starts at 1, and the mob is 8 + half the Suspicion: 9. Each round, the Storyteller rolls the ground on the chase table (Chapter 6). Round 1, a dead end: Wits d12 and the Monster, 12 + 3 = 15, Lead 2. Round 2, another dead end: 2 + 9 = 11, Lead 3, but the Monster showed: Suspicion 4, and the mob is now 10. Round 3, the festival parade, and out comes a sprig of rowan: her Weakness makes her Sly d10 a d8. She spends a charge on her Hedge Spell to raise it back and rolls 5 + 7 = 12: Lead 4, and she escapes. The Monster showed again: Suspicion 6. She is back at the baker, her Turn used up.

At the china shop, Dracula picks the lock of the front door with the Mask: Sly d6, a d8 with his Butler Duty, 7 + 2 = 9 against 8. The Creature takes the back room with Wits d10 and the Mask: 5 + 2 = 7, one short, a **Cost**. He has the tea service; the Storyteller picks the Cost. Dropping an item would cost nothing (he carries only what this roll won); of the rest, Suspicion +1 hurts most: a teacup smashes. Suspicion 7.

Turn 3. The Witch tries the shopkeeper again, and the Werewolf spends a charge on Good Dog for her (any ability can go on a friend's roll in the same place, for the charge but not the helper's action): she rolls the Monster without risking Suspicion. 7 + 4 = 11, a Success, and the wedding cake is hers. Dracula and the Creature move on to the ironmonger, which is watched: the Tell check is a 4, and a d6 between the two arrivals picks the Creature, who stands a head above the crowd. Suspicion 8.

Three Turns gone, nine to go. Both essentials are in hand, but Suspicion is 8 of 11: from here on, every Monster counts.



Entity Sheet

Copy for each player; fill it in from Chapter 2.

Player _____ **Entity** _____

Castle Duty _____ **Shops for** (one size bigger there) _____

BRAWN	NIMBLE	SLY	CHARM	WITS

One each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4. Second die: the **Mask d6** or the **Monster d10** (it shows if its number beats your trait die's: Suspicion +2).

Charges ○ ○ ○ extra charges (campaign, Chapter 7): ◌ ◌ ◌

at 0, use one anyway (overdraw: Suspicion +2; in the final flight, your Weakness from your next roll instead, once per flight, never while it's in play)

Signature (1 charge) _____

Gift (1 charge) _____

Perk (always on) _____

Weakness _____ ☐ Always (round 1) ☐ Soon (round 3)

Tell (goes off: Suspicion +1) _____

Form (Jekyll & Hyde: Jekyll's dice above, Hyde's below in each box; starts as Jekyll) ☐ Jekyll ☐ Hyde

CARRYING (LOOT)	FURNITURE	STATUS
		☐ In town ☐ Captured (lock-up) ☐ In the final flight ☐ Out of town

Cost to come ☐ next roll's trait die one size smaller ☐ next action lost

In a chase ☐ Weakness in play ☐ overdrawn this flight

One raise (one size bigger) per roll, from any source, Castle Duty included; never above a d12 or below a d4.

At the Table

THE ROLL (CHAPTER 3)

Your **trait die** (one the obstacle lists; in a chase, the ground) + the **Mask d6** or the **Monster d10**, against the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

- **Success:** equal to it or more.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. Done, but the Storyteller picks: Suspicion +1, drop an item, lose a Turn, or next die one size smaller.
- **Trouble:** 3+ short. You don't do it; Suspicion +1; caught if the obstacle is watched (a local chase).
- **Critical:** a Success on doubles: two Successes in a chase; anywhere else, a spent charge back.
- **Monster shows:** it outrolls your trait die. Suspicion +2.

ABILITIES (CHAPTER 3)

One charge each, before the roll, on yours or a friend's in the same place (not in a local chase), for no action. Make your trait die one size bigger; use the ability's trait; roll the Monster without risking Suspicion; or open your own approach with an unlisted trait (a Difficulty 2 lower; your own roll, and only you get past; never in a chase). **One raise per roll.** At zero charges, overdraw: Suspicion +2, or in the final flight your Weakness (once a flight, from your next roll).

TURNS (CHAPTER 4)

12 Turns, then dawn. Each Turn, each Entity takes one action: roll, move, pick up or wait. A beaten obstacle stays beaten, unless it's a **group** one (each who wants past rolls). At a location with your Duty's kind of item: trait die one size bigger (own rolls; the one raise; not in a chase). Carrying furniture (Bulky: one carrier; Huge: two): moves take two Turns, no Mask, Nimble one size smaller. Loot: no limit, handed over free. The way out (watched): Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way; one roll for all, everyone not captured there.

SUSPICION (CHAPTER 5)

Trouble +1 · the Monster shows +2 · the loud way +1 · a Cost chosen as Suspicion +1 · overdraw +2 · a Tell +1 (4–6 on a d6, the first time anyone reaches each watched place, the lock-up and the way out included; one arriving Entity's Tell) · furniture, each Turn once taken +1. **One roll, one rise**, by its biggest trigger. At the Limit, or at dawn, the hunt is on: the final flight.

CHASES (CHAPTER 6)

- **Local chase:** Lead 1, escape at 4, against 8 + half the Suspicion (at most 12); cornered at 0. The Mask allowed; abilities on your own roll only. Escape: back where you were caught, Turn used. Cornered: captured, and the town takes what you carry. At the lock-up (Difficulty 10, watched): slip free once a Turn from the next (Sly or Nimble, Brawn loud; Success only), or be rescued (Sly, Brawn loud; a Success or Cost frees all).
- **Final flight:** everyone not captured flees together; the Mask is off, Suspicion stops, abilities help anyone. Lead 2, escape at 5 (6 on Hard). Cornered: forked.
- Each round: roll the ground (the chase table); Success Lead +1 (Critical +2), Cost 0, Trouble –1. Several together: more Successes than Trouble, Lead +1 (+2 if ahead by 2 or more); more Trouble, –1 (–2); level, 0.
- Your Weakness: trait die one size smaller to the end of the chase (Always: round 1; Soon: round 3).

HOW THE YEAR WENT (CHAPTER 7)

Grand Year: a Win and a piece of furniture or decor. **Win:** every essential, at most one extra missing. **Partial:** at least half the list. **Bust:** less. Each Entity left behind: one step down.

	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Shopping list (essentials)	4 (1)	5 (1–2)	5 (2)
Suspicion Limit	11	11	15
The way out: Difficulty	6	8	10
The final flight: mob · escape at	10 · 5	11 · 5	11 · 6

D6	THE GROUND (A CHASE, EACH ROUND)	TRAITS THAT WORK
1	**The crowded square.** Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through.	Sly, Charm
2	**Back alleys.** Duck, dodge, double back.	Nimble, Sly
3	**The market stalls.** Overturn a cart, vault a stall.	Brawn, Nimble
4	**Over the rooftops.** Climb, jump, find a way down.	Nimble, Wits
5	**The festival parade.** Join in: you're in costume, after all.	Charm, Sly
6	**A dead end.** Break through, or think fast.	Brawn, Wits

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.

Every year, on Lantern Night, the whole town dresses up as monsters. Every year, a few real ones walk in with them.

You play Dracula, Frankenstein's Creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch or Jekyll & Hyde: housemates in a crumbling castle with a shopping list to fill before dawn. Hide behind the Mask, or let the Monster out and risk the town's Suspicion. Grab what the castle needs, and maybe a nice armchair. And if it all goes wrong, run, because the mob has pitchforks.



For 3–5 players and a Storyteller · 2–3 hours · ages 12+

DON'T GET FORKED · VERSION 0.1